
BIM488 Introduction to Pattern Recognition

Text Classification

Outline

- Introduction
- Text representation
- Text classification
- Term Selection

Introduction

- Text classification/categorization is a problem in information science.
- The task is to assign a document to one or more categories, based on its contents.

In other words:

- given a predefined set of categories and a set of documents
- label each document with one or more categories

Text representation

- selection of terms
- vector model
- weighting ($TD * IDF$)

Text representation

- text cannot be directly interpreted by the many document processing applications
- we need a compact representation of the content
- which are the meaningful units of text?

Terms

- Words
 - typical choice
 - set of words, bag of words
- Phrases
 - syntactical phrases (e.g. noun phrases)
 - statistical phrases (e.g. frequent pairs of words)
 - usefulness not yet known?

Terms

- **Stop-word removal:** part of the text is not considered as terms: these words can be removed
 - very common words (function words):
 - articles (a, the) , prepositions (of, in), conjunctions (and, or), adverbs (here, then)
 - numerals (30.9.2002, 2547)
- other preprocessing steps
 - **Stemming** (i.e., apples → apple)

Vector model

- a document is often represented as a vector
- the vector has as many dimensions as there are terms in the whole collection of documents

Vector model

- Assume in a sample document collection, there are 100 words (terms)
- In alphabetical order, the list of terms starts with:
 - absorption
 - agriculture
 - anaemia
 - analyse
 - application
 - ...

Vector model

- Each document can be represented by a vector of 100 dimensions
- We can think a document vector as an array of 100 elements, one for each term, indexed, e.g. 0-99

Vector model

- let $d1$ be the vector for document 1
- record only which terms occur in document:
 - $d1[0] = 0$ -- absorption doesn't occur
 - $d1[1] = 0$ -- agriculture -"-
 - $d1[2] = 0$ -- anaemia -"-
 - $d1[3] = 0$ -- analyse -"-
 - $d1[4] = 1$ -- application occurs
 - ...
 - $d1[21] = 1$ -- current occurs
 - ...

Weighting terms

- usually we want to say that some terms are more important (for some document) than the others -> weighting
- weights usually range between 0 and 1
 - 1 denotes presence, 0 absence of the term in the document

Weighting terms

- if a word occurs many times in a document, it may be more important
 - but what about very frequent words?
- often the **TF*IDF** function is used
 - higher weight, if the term occurs often in the document
 - lower weight, if the term occurs in many documents

Weighting terms: TF*IDF

- TF*IDF = term frequency * inversed document frequency
- weight of term t_k in document d_j :

$$tfidf(t_k, d_j) = \#(t_k, d_j) \cdot \log \frac{|Tr|}{\#Tr(t_k)}$$

- where
 - $\#(t_k, d_j)$: the number of times t_k occurs in d_j
 - $\#Tr(t_k)$: the number of documents in Tr in which t_k occurs
 - Tr : the documents in the collection

Weighting terms: TF*IDF

- in document 1:
 - term 'application' occurs once, and in the whole collection it occurs in 2 documents:
 - $\text{tfidf}(\text{application}, d1) = 1 * \log(10/2) = \log 5 \sim 0.7$
 - term 'current' occurs once, in the whole collection in 9 documents:
 - $\text{tfidf}(\text{current}, d1) = 1 * \log(10/9) \sim 0.05$

Weighting terms: TF*IDF

- if there were some word that occurs 7 times in doc 1 and only in doc 1, the TF*IDF weight would be:
 - $\text{tfidf}(\text{doc1word}, d1) = 7 * \log(10/1) = 7$

Weighting terms: normalization

- in order for the weights to fall in the $[0,1]$ interval, the weights are often normalized (T is the set of terms):

$$w_{kj} = \frac{tfidf(t_k, d_j)}{\sqrt{\sum_{s=1}^{|T|} (tfidf(t_s, d_j))^2}}$$

Text categorization

- two major approaches:
 - knowledge engineering -> end of 80's
 - manually defined set of rules encoding expert knowledge on how to classify documents under the given categories
 - machine learning, 90's ->
 - an automatic text classifier is built by learning, from a set of preclassified documents, the characteristics of the categories

Single-label, multi-label TC

- single-label text categorization
 - exactly 1 category must be assigned to each $d_j \in D$
- multi-label text categorization
 - any number of categories may be assigned to the same $d_j \in D$

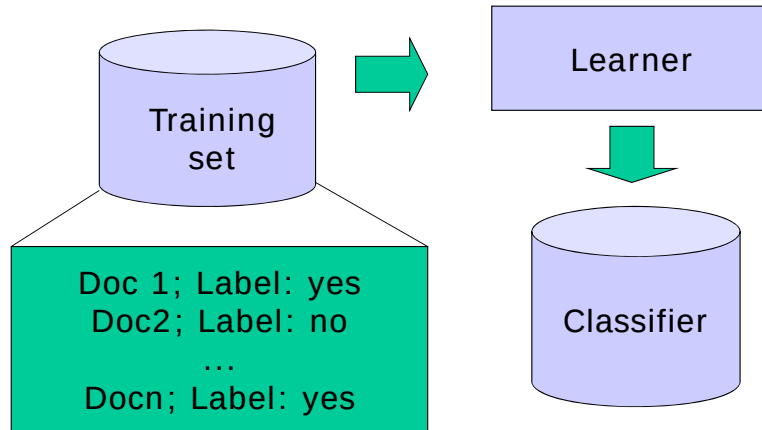
Single-label, multi-label TC

- special case of single-label: binary
 - each d_j must be assigned either to category c_i or to its complement $\neg c_i$
- the binary case (and, hence, the single-label case) is more general than the multi-label
 - an algorithm for binary classification can also be used for multi-label classification
 - the converse is not true

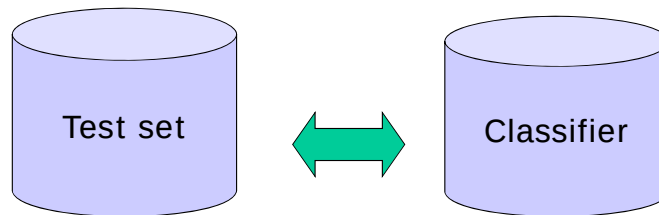
Machine learning approach

- a general inductive process (learner) automatically builds a classifier for a category c_i by observing the characteristics of a set of documents manually classified under c_i or $\neg c_i$ by a domain expert
- from these characteristics the learner extracts the characteristics that a new unseen document should have in order to be classified under c_i
- use of classifier: the classifier observes the characteristics of a new document and decides whether it should be classified under c_i or $\neg c_i$

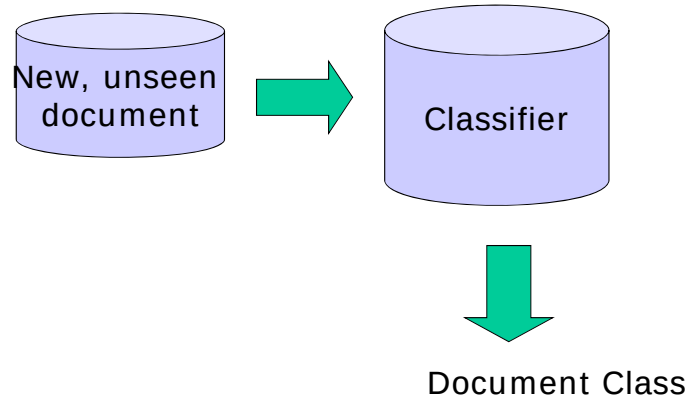
Classification process: classifier construction



Classification process: testing the classifier



Classification process: use of the classifier



Strengths of machine learning approach

- the learner is domain independent
 - usually available 'off-the-shelf'
- the inductive process is easily repeated, if the set of categories changes
 - only the training set has to be replaced
- manually classified documents often already available
 - manual process may exist
 - if not, it is still easier to manually classify a set of documents than to build and tune a set of rules

Examples of learners

- Rocchio method
- probabilistic classifiers (Naïve Bayes)
- decision tree classifiers
- decision rule classifiers
- regression methods
- on-line methods
- neural networks
- example-based classifiers (k-NN)
- boosting methods
- support vector machines

Term selection

- a large document collection may contain millions of words -> document vectors would contain millions of dimensions
 - many algorithms cannot handle high dimensionality of the term space (= large number of terms)
 - very specific terms may lead to overfitting: the classifier can classify the documents in the training data well but fails often with unseen documents

Term selection

- usually only a part of terms is used
- how to select terms that are used?
 - term selection (often called feature selection or dimensionality reduction) methods

Term selection

- goal: select terms that yield the highest effectiveness in the given application
- wrapper approach
 - the reduced set of terms is found iteratively and tested with the application
- filtering approach
 - keep the terms that receive the highest score according to a function that measures the "importance" of the term for the task

Term selection

- many functions available
 - document frequency: keep the high frequency terms
 - stopwords have been already removed
 - 50% of the words occur only once in the document collection
 - e.g. remove all terms occurring in at most 3 documents

Term selection functions: document frequency

- document frequency is the number of documents in which a term occurs
- in our sample, the ranking of terms:
 - 9 current
 - 7 project
 - 4 environment
 - 3 nuclear
 - 2 application
 - 2 area ... 2 water
 - 1 use ...

Term selection functions: document frequency

- we might now set the threshold to 2 and remove all the words that occur only once
- result: 25 words of 100 words (~25%) selected

Term selection: other functions

- Information-theoretic term selection functions, e.g.
 - chi-square
 - information gain
 - mutual information
 - odds ratio
 - relevancy score

Term selection: information gain

- Information gain: measures the (number of bits of) information obtained for category prediction by knowing the presence or absence of a term in a document
- information gain is calculated for each term and the best n terms are selected

Term selection: IG

- information gain for term t :
 - m : the number of categories

$$\begin{aligned} G(t) = & -\sum_{i=1}^m p(c_i) \log p(c_i) \\ & + p(t) \sum_{i=1}^m p(c_i | t) \log p(c_i | t) \\ & + p(\sim t) \sum_{i=1}^m p(c_i | \sim t) \log p(c_i | \sim t) \end{aligned}$$

Estimating probabilities

2 classes: c and $\sim c$

- (c) Doc 1: cat cat cat
- (c) Doc 2: cat cat cat dog
- ($\sim c$) Doc 3: cat dog mouse
- ($\sim c$) Doc 4: cat cat cat dog dog dog
- ($\sim c$) Doc 5: mouse

Term selection: estimating probabilities

- $P(t)$: probability of a term t
 - $P(\text{cat}) = 4/5$, or
 - 'cat' occurs in 4 docs of 5
 - $P(\text{cat}) = 10/17$
 - the proportion of the occurrences of 'cat' of the all term occurrences

Term selection: estimating probabilities

- $P(\sim t)$: probability of the absence of t
 - $P(\sim \text{cat}) = 1/5$, or
 - $P(\sim \text{cat}) = 7/17$

Term selection: estimating probabilities

- $P(c_i)$: probability of category i
 - $P(c) = 2/5$ (the proportion of documents belonging to c in the collection), or
 - $P(c) = 7/17$ (7 of the 17 terms occur in the documents belonging to c)

Term selection: estimating probabilities

- $P(c_i | t)$: probability of category i if t is in the document; i.e., which proportion of the documents where t occurs belong to the category i
 - $P(c | \text{cat}) = 2/4$ (or $6/10$)
 - $P(\sim c | \text{cat}) = 2/4$ (or $4/10$)
 - $P(c | \text{mouse}) = 0$
 - $P(\sim c | \text{mouse}) = 1$

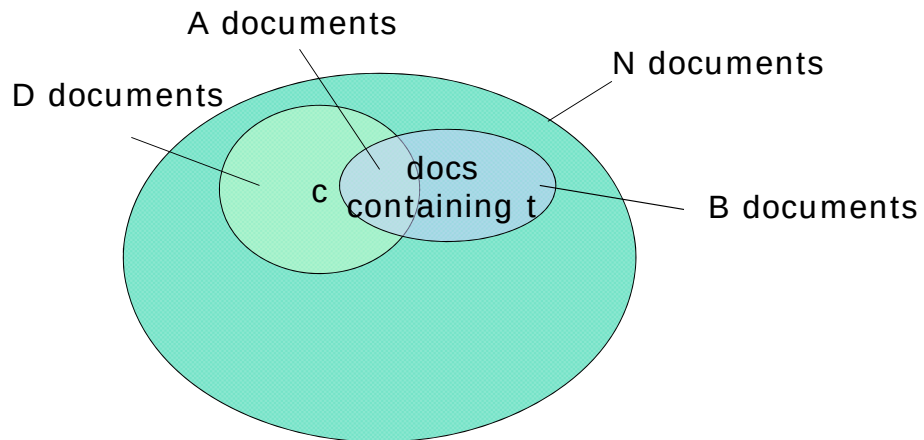
Term selection: estimating probabilities

- $P(c_i | \sim t)$: probability of category i if t is not in the document; i.e., which proportion of the documents where t does not occur belongs to the category i
 - $P(c | \sim \text{cat}) = 0$ (or $1/7$)
 - $P(c | \sim \text{dog}) = \frac{1}{2}$ (or $6/12$)
 - $P(c | \sim \text{mouse}) = \frac{2}{3}$ (or $7/15$)

Term selection: estimating probabilities

- In other words...
- Let
 - term t occurs in B documents, A of them are in category c
 - category c has D documents, of the whole of N documents in the collection

Term selection: estimating probabilities



Term selection: estimating probabilities

- For instance,
 - $P(t)$: B/N
 - $P(\sim t)$: $(N-B)/N$
 - $P(c)$: D/N
 - $P(c|t)$: A/B
 - $P(c|\sim t)$: $(D-A)/(N-B)$

Term selection: IG

- information gain for a term t :

$$G(t) = -\sum_{i=1}^m p(c_i) \log p(c_i) \\ + p(t) \sum_{i=1}^m p(c_i | t) \log p(c_i | t) + p(\sim t) \sum_{i=1}^m p(c_i | \sim t) \log p(c_i | \sim t)$$

- $G(\text{cat}) = 0.17$
- $G(\text{dog}) = 0.02$
- $G(\text{mouse}) = 0.42$

Summary

- Introduction
- Text representation
- Text classification
- Term Selection

References

- 582410 Processing of large document collections, Lecture Notes, University of Helsinki.

